world from nuclear Armageddon. What is interesting about *16 December* is the way in which it 'naturalizes' surveillance technologies (CCTV cameras, satellite-based video surveillance, human surveillance through street based 'agents' who happen to be an army of blind beggars with sharp ears, and mobile phone interception), to produce a seamless evidentiary narrative. Mobile phones are high technology, the capacity to tap mobile phones is still higher technology and truth flows out of higher technology. What is even more interesting is a remarkable sequence in the film when the entire intelligence apparatus connives to create a 'simulation', an image of a location in far away Afghanistan on the floor of a 'film studio' so as to hoodwink a drugged and captured 'terrorist' into talking. This tacit admission of the practice by intelligence agencies of 'staging' incidents relating to 'terrorism' as a measure necessary in order to combat terrorists is almost like a sudden revelation of the 'repressed' narrative of how intelligence agencies actually create the realities that we think they are combatting. One might recall also the climactic revelation in the Sanjay Dutt–Jackie Shroff–Hrithik Roshan starrer *Mission Kashmir* (with its own oblique references to the enigmatic figure of 'Ghazi Baba') of how a 'video simulation' of 'terrorists in Indian Army uniforms' (found during the course of a raid by Indian military personnel dressed as 'terrorists' on a 'terrorist hideout') blowing up a Muslim holy shrine in Srinagar in Kashmir is yet another instance of the way in which the 'production of images' is seen as key to the 'production of terror'. The deliberate confusion in the appearance of combatants in and out of uniform, of masked men who appear in the middle of the night and wreak devastating violence, in the pursuit of an 'image', who could be 'militants' or 'soldiers' or 'both', is a reflection of the shadowy realities that have overtaken Jammu and Kashmir. Here, as we observed earlier, we know who is who, even though the 'terrorist' both 'stands out' and 'blends in' at the same time. It is as if the apparatus of illusion that is the cinema had taught many lessons to the secondary art of the moving image of statecraft, at least in its 'terror/counter-terror' avatar.

Seen in the light of the extraordinary 'entente cordiale' between security and intelligence agencies and the image-producing agencies of the media in India, the film *16 December* becomes an interesting if unwitting source for the making of an oblique comment on the reality of '13 December'.

In a similar, though perhaps more conscious vein, the film *Khakee* (starring Amitabh Bachchan, Akshay Kumar, Ajay Devgan, Atul Kulkarni and